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Hard Skills: Definition, Examples, and What to Include on Your Resume

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Did you know that [88%](#) of hiring managers and recruiters focus on hard skills when reading your resume?

With [skills-based hiring](#) on the rise in the world of recruitment, listing your relevant hard skills on your resume is more important than ever.

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Example of an ATS resume that shows you can meet all your resume requirements and pass the ATS filter

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N'S SKILL REPORT DATA:

1. AI
2. Data analysis
3. Project management
4. Cloud computing
5. Marketing
6. Management
7. Computer science
8. Reporting
9. Design
10. Sales

Find industry and job-specific skills with our [targeted skills reports](#).

What are hard skills?

[Hard skills](#) are specific, measurable, and teachable knowledge or expertise you need to do a job effectively. These skills are often industry-specific or role-specific and can be developed through education, training, and on-the-job experience.

Examples of hard skills include proficiency in data analysis, accounting, cloud computing, programming, foreign languages, project management, and operating machinery.

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help you work with other people. In fact, soft skills are often called “people skills” or

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[Examples of soft skills](#) include [communication](#), [time management](#), [organization](#), collaboration, and [Dashboard](#)

Soft skills are also [transferable](#). This means they can be used in any type of job in any field. This isn't the case with hard skills.

[Hard and soft skills](#) are different, but both are important. Having a variety of hard and soft skills on your resume shows you're a well-rounded candidate.



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For [Dashboard](#) such as “proficiency in SQL, Tableau, and Python” on your resume if you’re applying for a data analyst role. These hard skills confirm and show recruiters you can handle the role’s technical requirements.

Listing hard skills on your resume is important because they:

1. Boost your employability

Possessing in-demand hard skills makes you a desirable candidate in the job market. Employers want candidates who can contribute immediately to their organization. Hard skills help you secure job offers and increase your chances of employment. They show you have the [technical expertise](#) and practical knowledge needed to perform the job well.

2. Enhance your job performance

Hard skills enable you to perform your job effectively and efficiently. They ensure you meet industry standards and achieve professional goals. With strong hard skills, you can complete tasks accurately and on time. This leads to better job performance and job satisfaction.

3. Help advance your career

Having relevant hard skills can lead to promotions and career advancement. Employers are more likely to invest in employees with the skills necessary to take on higher responsibilities. As you acquire more skills, you can qualify for more advanced roles.

Check which skills you should list on your resume to get noticed by recruiters [Skip to content](#)



Types of hard skills

Different industries require different hard skills. For instance, key hard skills in finance include financial modeling, budgeting, and using specialized software like QuickBooks.

Understanding the different types of hard skills is essential when [writing a standout resume](#). Here are different types of the [most in-demand hard skills](#).

1. Technical skills

- **Coding Languages:** Competence in programming languages like Python, Java, or C++.
- **Database Management:** Expertise in SQL, Oracle, or database administration.
- **Web Development:** Skills in HTML, CSS, JavaScript, and front-end frameworks like React.
- **Networking:** Knowledge of setting up and maintaining network systems, including VPNs and firewalls.
- **Cybersecurity:** Understanding of encryption, security protocols, and vulnerability assessment tools.

2. Computer skills

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- **Adobe Creative Suite:** Skills in Photoshop, Illustrator, InDesign, and Premiere Pro.

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Tableau, Power BI, or Google Data Studio.

- **Project Management Software:** Familiarity with tools like Trello, Asana, and Monday.com.

3. Industry-specific skills

- **Finance:** Financial modeling, use of QuickBooks, and risk analysis.
- **Healthcare:** Patient care software, medical coding, and HIPAA compliance.
- **Engineering:** CAD software like AutoCAD, SolidWorks, and structural analysis tools.
- **Marketing:** SEO, Google Analytics, and PPC advertising.
- **Education:** Familiarity with Learning Management Systems (LMS) like Moodle, curriculum development, and online teaching tools.

4. Analytical skills

- **Data Analysis:** Ability to interpret data sets using software such as Excel or SPSS.
- **Statistical Analysis:** Proficiency in using R or Python for statistical computations.
- **Critical Thinking:** Skill in assessing complex situations and making reasoned decisions.
- **Research Skills:** Conducting and summarizing research for reports.

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5. Project management skills

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- **Project Planning:** Ability to set up project timelines and milestones.
- **Agile Methodologies:** Experience with frameworks like Scrum or Kanban.
- **Budget Management:** Skill in managing finances and cost analysis.
- **Risk Management:** Identifying potential project risks and mitigation planning.
- **Resource Allocation:** Efficiently managing and distributing project resources.

6. Creative skills

- **Graphic Design:** Proficiency in Adobe Photoshop and Illustrator for designing visuals.
- **Video Editing:** Skills in software like Adobe Premiere Pro and Final Cut Pro.
- **Copywriting:** Ability to write compelling and persuasive content.
- **Photography:** Expertise in taking, editing, and presenting professional photos.
- **Content Creation:** Creating engaging content for blogs, social media, and websites.

7. Administrative skills

- **Scheduling:** Organizing appointments and managing calendars effectively.

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- **Bookkeeping:** Handling basic financial transactions and records

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More examples of hard skills

Here are other examples of hard [resume skills](#) you can include on your resume:

1. Bilingual or multilingual
2. Adobe software suite
3. Network security
4. SEO/SEM marketing
5. Statistical analysis
6. Data mining
7. Programming languages (like Perl, Python, Java, and Ruby)
8. Payroll accounting
9. Microsoft Excel
10. Video editing
11. Salesforce
12. Heavy equipment operation
13. Graphic design
14. User experience (UX) design/User interface (UI) design
15. Google Analytics

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[19. Social media and marketing management](#)

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[20. Project management](#)

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[22. Artificial Intelligence \(AI\)](#)

[23. Machine Learning \(ML\)](#)

[24. Data Analysis](#)

[25. Cloud Computing](#)

[26. Cybersecurity](#)

[27. Blockchain Development](#)

[28. Python Programming](#)

[29. JavaScript](#)

[30. DevOps](#)

[31. Internet of Things \(IoT\)](#)

[32. SQL and Database Management](#)

[33. Big Data Analysis](#)

[34. Business Intelligence](#)

[35. Data Visualization \(Tableau, Power BI\)](#)

[36. Statistical Analysis \(R, SAS\)](#)

[37. Predictive Analytics](#)

[38. ETL \(Extract, Transform, Load\)](#)

[39. Data Warehousing](#)

[40. Natural Language Processing \(NLP\)](#)

[41. Data Cleaning](#)

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[44. Mechanical Design](#)

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[48. Circuit Design](#)

[49. Materials Engineering](#)

[50. Product Lifecycle Management \(PLM\)](#)

[51. Industrial Maintenance](#)

[52. Search Engine Optimization \(SEO\)](#)

[53. Paid Digital Advertising \(PPC, Google Ads\)](#)

[54. Content Marketing](#)

[55. Social Media Strategy](#)

[56. UX/UI Design](#)

[57. Video Production and Editing](#)

[58. Branding Strategy](#)

[59. Graphic Design \(Adobe Creative Suite\)](#)

[60. Copywriting](#)

[61. Email Marketing](#)

[62. Financial Analysis and Forecasting](#)

[63. Strategic Planning](#)

[64. Risk Management](#)

[65. Supply Chain Management](#)

[66. Sales Strategy Development](#)

[67. Contract Management](#)

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How to choose what hard skills to include on your resume

How do you know which hard skills you should add to your resume? Here are three simple tips for choosing the best hard skills to highlight on your resume.

1. Tailor hard skills to the job description

Tailoring your hard skills to match the job description is critical because most companies use [applicant tracking systems](#) (ATS) to streamline their hiring process.

When you submit your resume, it goes right into an ATS database. Recruiters then search the database for suitable [job candidates](#) by typing in [keywords](#). These keywords are usually [job titles](#) or hard skills.

So your resume needs to contain those keywords. Otherwise, your resume will not be seen by recruiters, no matter how qualified you are for the job.

[Tailoring your resume for the job](#) you're applying for will get you better results. Unfortunately, it's also time-consuming. That's why most people don't do it.

To save you time and energy, you can use free online tools like Jobscan's [resume scanner](#).

When you scan your resume into Jobscan, it analyzes both your resume and job description and comes up with a list of hard skills you need to incorporate into your resume.

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.....the job description, your cover letter, and your resume or resume cover letter.

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Jobscan's match report alerts you of missing hard skills found in the job description. Using the report, you can better optimize your resume by ensuring you include the most critical hard skills needed for the role.

As you can see, the resume scanner will analyze the number of times a hard skill is mentioned in the job description and show if your resume mentions them just as frequently. The scanner also notes hard skills that are missing from your resume. Above, you can see that the scanned

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Or paste resume text

2. Focus on your relevant expertise

If you have a wide range of hard skills, it might be tempting to list all of them on your resume. However, including too many skills can be overwhelming and may actually hurt your chances.

So, you should not list every hard skill you possess. Instead, only select those skills directly applicable to the job you're applying for. This also helps recruiters reviewing your resume not

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Let's say you're applying for a graphic designer role. When writing your resume, you

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ability to design, communicate visually, and

Create compelling user experiences.

Relevant hard skills to highlight include proficiency in:

- Adobe creative suite
- Typography
- UI/UX design

Do not include unrelated hard skills, such as coding languages or data analysis. They don't add value to the recruiter and may dilute the strength of your application.

3. Quantify your hard skills

To make your resume stand out, give specific examples that back up your proficiency and quantify the impact of those skills. Instead of just stating that you have a specific hard skill, show recruiters how you've applied it successfully. Here are a few examples:

- **Excel Skills:** "Streamlined data entry and analysis, reducing project completion time by 30% using advanced Excel functions like VLOOKUP and pivot tables."
- **Project Management:** "Led a cross-functional team to complete a product launch ahead of schedule, using project management tools and techniques to improve team productivity by 15%."
- **Customer Service:** "Enhanced customer satisfaction scores by 25% through effective use of CRM software and perso

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leading to increased

How to showcase your hard skills

Identifying your hard skills and their relevance to a specific job is just the beginning. To succeed in your job search, you have to effectively highlight your skills to show hiring managers you have the skills they're looking for to do the job.

You can effectively show off your hard skills in a range of methods.

Hard skills on your resume

There are four [resume sections](#) where you should try to add your hard skills:

1. Resume headline

Your [resume headline](#) is a one-line phrase at the top of your resume, right beneath your contact information. The purpose of the headline is to quickly tell the hiring manager who you are.

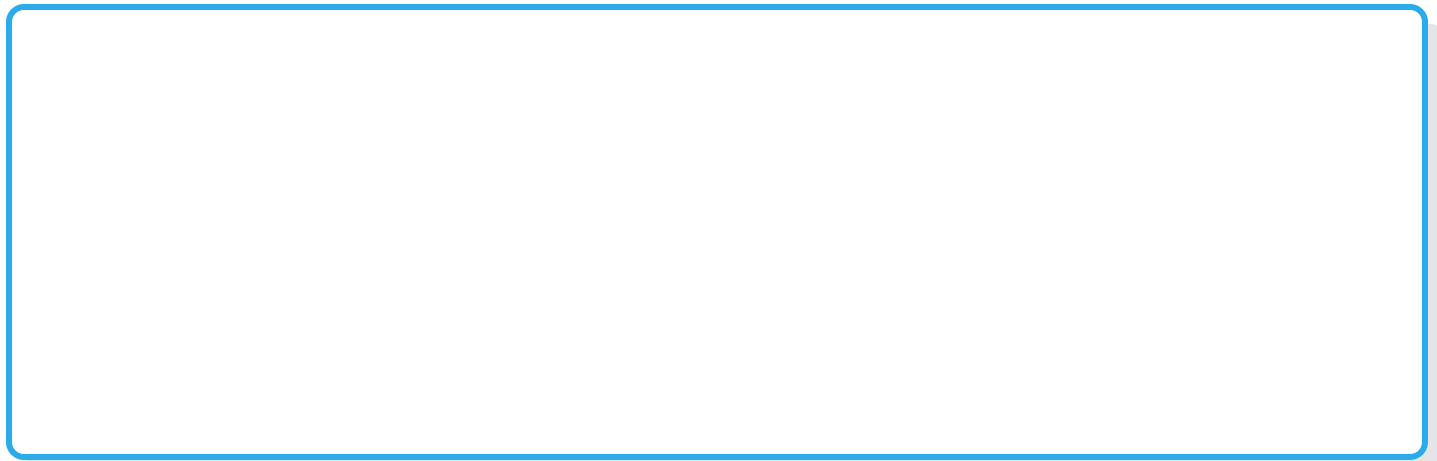
While many job seekers use the resume headline to clearly state their job title or target role, it's also a great place to highlight valuable hard skills right at the top of your resume. When you emphasize the most critical skills, the hiring manager will see them right away and encourage them to keep reading.

Here's an [example of a resume](#) headline for a software developer:

2. Resume summary

Your [resume summary](#) appears right beneath your resume headline. Your summary is a brief statement that highlights your skills, experience, and [professional accomplishments](#). Including the most important hard skills in the resume summary keeps the information at the top of the page, so when the reader scans your resume, the hard skills are some of the first details they see.

Here's an example of a resume summary that features a variety of hard skills:



3. Skills section

The most obvious place to put your skills on your resume is your skills section. If you're using a [chronological resume](#) format the skills section will usually go below your [work experience](#). On a [hybrid resume](#), the skills section typically goes above your work experience.

You can either use [bullet points](#) to list your skills or separate them by vertical bars, commas, or some other separator. Here's an example:

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4. Work experience section

The [work experience section](#) is the heart of your resume and a great place to add your hard skills.

Always try to start each bullet point with an [action verb](#), such as “Implemented,” “Initiated,” or “Spearheaded.” Whenever possible, try to use numbers and metrics to describe your accomplishments.

Here’s an example of a work experience section with plenty of hard skills:

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Hard skills in your cover letter

Your [cover letter](#) is the best place to expand on specific points in your resume and apply your experience to the particular employer. It's also an underrated place to mention hard skills and keywords from the job description.

Below is an example of a cover letter with the hard skills in bold. The ATS can parse cover letters, so it's a great place to restate your most important hard skills.

hard skills with a hiring team. During your [job interview](#), weave your answers with [measurable](#)

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Use the STAR method (situation, task, action, result) to answer your [interview questions](#) with
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How to develop your hard skills

You can acquire and practice hard skills in a range of methods.

1. Formal education

Attending university or college is a traditional way to acquire hard skills. Many institutions offer specialized courses tailored to specific career paths. Besides having the education accomplishments listed on your resume, these courses provide structured learning and expert guidance. For example, a computer science degree teaches programming and software development.

Read more: [How to Format Your Resume Education Section](#)

2. Online courses and certifications

There are plenty of online platforms, like [Coursera](#), [Udemy](#), and [LinkedIn Learning](#), that offer courses on various hard skills. These platforms allow you to learn at your own pace and convenience. You can choose from a wide range of subjects to suit your career goals.

Certifications can also help validate your hard skills and make you stand out to employers. Examples include CompTIA for IT pros, PMP for project managers, and Google Analytics for marketers. These certifications demonstrate your expertise and commitment to your field.

Read more: [75+ Free Certifications to Help You](#) [Skip to content](#) [b](#)

and entry-level positions provide practical knowledge and skills. These opportunities allow you to gain hands-on experience and develop your skills. Professional resume writers and resume consultants help you gain insights and improve your abilities.

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4. Self-study and hobbies

Self-study involves learning through books, tutorials, and practice. This method requires discipline but allows you to gain expertise in your own time. You can focus on topics that interest you and learn at your own pace. Self-study is a flexible way to develop hard skills without formal education.

Engaging in hobbies can also help build your hard skills. Consider taking up a hobby tied to your career—or your career of choice if you're [changing careers](#). For example, if you're looking to transition into a social media role, mention hobbies like graphic design or video editing. They can be valuable hard skills to highlight on your resume.

Want to optimize your hard skills for applicant tracking systems?

[Scan Your Resume for Free!](#)

Key takeaways

Here are key pointers to remember:

- Hard skills are technical abilities and knowledge that are directly relevant to specific roles and industries.

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It is crucial to tailor your hard skills to the job you are applying for.

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Frequently asked questions

What are hard skills to include on a resume?

Examples of hard skills include data analysis, programming, graphic design, foreign language proficiency, machine operation, SEO, marketing, project management, accounting, social media management, and cybersecurity.

What are some easy hard skills?

Some hard skills might be considered easier to learn because they may require less time to understand the basics or have more accessible learning resources available. Here are a few examples:

- Computer skills
- Social media management
- Data entry
- Office software
- Customer service software
- Basic math
- Language proficiency
- Email communication
- File management
- Basic graphic design

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Hard skills vs. soft skills?

Hard skills are learned skills that are job-specific. They tend to be more technical, and they're necessary for completing day-to-day work. Soft skills, on the other hand, focus more on characteristics and personal attributes like teamwork, communication, and time management. They translate across most fields and careers.

What are hard skills?

Hard skills are specific, measurable, and teachable knowledge or expertise you need to do a job effectively. These skills are often industry-specific or role-specific and can be developed through education, training, and on-the-job experience.

How can you acquire hard skills?

Hard skills can be learned through formal education, online courses, certifications, and hands-on experience.

Why are hard skills important?

Hard skills are essential because they demonstrate your ability to perform job-specific tasks and are often required qualifications for job positions.

Is critical thinking a hard skill?

No. Critical thinking is a soft skill. It is not a technical ability you can measure or learn through training.

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Kelsey Purcell

Kelsey is a Content Writer with a background in content creation, bouncing between industries to educate readers everywhere. Not too long ago, she was a new grad and making a career change so she's thrilled to generate content to help job seekers. When she's not writing, you can find her touring her local coffee shops and browsing the bookstores for the latest reads.

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